

Get your site up
and running with
WordPress



Construction Complete

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Every business needs a place on the web, and the quicker you can get a functional web site up, the better. There are a number of great open source content management systems (CMSs) to help you start and run a web site, but you'll need time to figure them out – and while you do, your site's visitors must bear with the “under construction” sign on your home page. WordPress, meanwhile, stands out as one that's extremely flexible, easy to set up, and easy to customise.

Need to know

Before you run off to start creating a WordPress-based site, there are a few things you need to remember. First, WordPress is best for a site that is regularly updated, so it's perfect if a business blog or newsfeed is part of your plan, but overkill if all you want is a few static pages.

Secondly, WordPress still is, at its core, a blogging engine. The default WordPress installation looks like a blog, so don't plan on using that for your website. The good news is that there are a number of WordPress themes tailored for all sorts small businesses, and if you have some skills with CSS layouts (which aren't hard to

obtain), you can design a theme of your own in a day or two.

Thirdly, while WordPress's core features are impressive on their own, they aren't tailored for businesses. It doesn't have any ad management features, for instance, nor does it have any site statistics built in. Again, this is easily remedied—WordPress has a huge database of plugins that'll add these functions to your site, and installing them is embarrassingly easy.

Finally, before you begin setting up WordPress, you'll need to have some information handy:

- A MySQL username and password for your site (you can get this from your site's host)

- The ability to access your site's files via FTP
- The latest version of WordPress, from wordpress.org/download.

Setting it up

Several hosting providers provide you with cPanel or an equivalent – a simple control panel for you to administer your website – which will let you install WordPress without needing any configuration. Even if you don't have this feature, installing WordPress is simple enough.

Before beginning, create a new database in MySQL – this will hold all the content and information for your site. Unzip the WordPress archive that